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New Construction Buyer List

Go in with a list, not just a model home tour.

Builders have their own agents and contracts, and you are allowed to have your own representation. Bring this list to your first visit and ask the builder to answer in writing.

1. Before your first visit

- [ ] Pre-approval or proof of funds ready.
- [ ] Budget set, including taxes, insurance, and HOA or CDD fees, not only the price.
- [ ] Have your own agent involved before you visit. Many builders ask who represents you on the first visit, and it can be hard to add an agent afterward.
- [ ] Wish list split into must-haves and nice-to-haves.
- [ ] Two or three builders or communities picked to compare, not just one.

2. Questions for the builder

- [ ] What is included in the base price, and what costs extra?
- [ ] Which lots are available and what premiums apply?
- [ ] What incentives are offered, and do they require using the builder's lender or title company?
- [ ] What is the estimated completion date, and what happens if it slips?
- [ ] Can I see floor plans, specs, and a written list of standard finishes?
- [ ] Which items can I change, and by when must selections be final?
- [ ] Who builds the home: the builder's own crews or subcontractors?

3. Contract and deposit

- [ ] Read the whole contract. Builder contracts are usually written to favor the builder.
- [ ] Deposit amount, when it is due, and when it is refundable written down.
- [ ] Price adjustments, change order rules, and fees understood.
- [ ] Delay, cancellation, and closing date terms understood.
- [ ] Warranty terms and what they cover provided in writing.
- [ ] Consider having a real estate attorney review the contract.

4. Upgrades and options

- [ ] Get every upgrade priced in writing before you commit.

- [ ] Think about what is hard to change later (structural options, lot, flooring layout) versus easy to change later (paint, fixtures).
- [ ] Ask what upgrades are worth it for resale in this community.

5. Inspections during the build

- [ ] Schedule an independent inspector at key stages, for example before the slab pour, at framing, before drywall, and at final.
- [ ] Ask the builder for access rules for visits and inspections in advance.
- [ ] Keep photos and notes at every visit.
- [ ] Do a detailed final walkthrough with a punch list before closing.
- [ ] Do not rely only on the municipal inspection. It does not replace your own inspection.

6. Ongoing costs and community

- [ ] HOA fees, CDD fees, and any special assessments confirmed in writing.
- [ ] Flood zone, insurance quotes, and wind coverage checked for the lot.
- [ ] Community rules reviewed (parking, fences, rentals, exterior changes).
- [ ] Warranty process understood: who to call, how long coverage lasts, how to submit claims.
- [ ] Plan a walkthrough near the end of the first year to document anything for the warranty.

7. Red flags to slow down for

- [ ] Pressure to sign today or lose an incentive.
- [ ] Verbal promises that are not in the contract.
- [ ] Refusal to allow independent inspections.
- [ ] Vague answers about fees, completion dates, or what is included.
- [ ] Reviews or reputation that you have not checked yourself.

Next step: Want a second set of eyes on a builder contract or community? Contact Tony before you sign anything.
Call or text **813-345-7487** | tonino.damiano@exprealty.com | toninodamiano.exprealty.com | YouTube: @tonyinvestorfriendlyrealto

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